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Editorial Correspondence.

THE OLD TOWN OF MACHIAS.

Early History,—Historical papers of W. B. Smith, Esq.,—Territorial extent of the old town,—Richard Vines' Establishment in 1633,—Is dispossessed by La Tour,—Romantic Tradition of Madame La Tour,—Winthrop's account of the attack of La Tour,—Intermediate history of Machias,—The great drought of 1761,—It causes the settlement of Machias,—Arrival of the Pioneers of the Settlement from Scarborough,—Mills Erected,—Hardships of the first Winter,—Revolutionary Period,—News of the Battle of Lexington,—Capt. Jones' Sloops detained,—Taking of the Margaretta,—Repulse of the Attack of Sir George Collier,—The British Destroy the Fortifications in 1814.

It is indeed a laudable work to rescue from oblivion any fact which tends to throw light upon the lives and actions of the pioneers of Maine, or serves to freshen in the memories of their descendants the recollection of the patriotism and the enduring courage of those who first opened our forests and produced the fruits of a cultivated soil. In this field there are few more attractive localities than the old town of Machias. Its history dates back to only thirteen years later than the landing at Plymouth,—the same privations and toils that have so endeared to us the memories of our Massachusetts ancestry, were common to their northeastern brethren,—the same spirit that animated the heroes of Lexington and Bunker Hill, inspired in an eminent degree the patriots here, and saved to the original thirteen states that beautiful territory in Maine lying east of the Penobscot:—and above all, here was the first essay at naval enterprise, on the part of that country which at this moment acknowledges no compeer upon the waves. Cooper, in his "Naval History," speaking of the capture of the Margaretta by the people of Machias, calls the locality of the conflict "The Lexington of the Seas." The history of Machias during the period of the revolution, presents many examples of collective and personal bravery, and exhibits a patriotism on the part of the people which has in no country or time been more strikingly shown, if we consider numbers and ability. Such spirit would have done a people honor in that far remote period,

> "When Spartan firmness braved the wrecks of time,
> Or Latian virtue fanned the heroic flame."

Our task of presenting even a brief sketch of Machias would be almost a hopeless one, were it not that we are allowed to avail ourselves of the results of the careful research of Wm. B. Smith, Esq., of this town. About ten years since, Mr. S. prepared two lectures upon the colonial and revolutionary history of the place, and by his politeness the manuscript is before us. We are happy to add that, without doubt, the papers in his possession, with many data not embraced in them, will, before long, be fully elaborated, and find a more enduring form in the pages of a local history.

The old town of Machias (from Mechisses, its Indian name,) embraced what has been divided into Whitneyville, Marshfield, East Machias, Machiasport, and Machias. In speaking of "Machias" historically, its territory must be understood as embracing all these.

It will not be necessary, in this sketch, to enter minutely into an examination of the conflicting claims to rights on the coast of Maine, which so vexed the times of the early settlers. In the spring of 1633, Richard Vines, of Saco, established a trading house at Machias, under a grant by the Plymouth colony to Isaac Allerton and himself, by which the right to trade with the Indians on the coast of Maine was secured to them. At this time D'Aulney and La Tour were rival claimants to the country, from Cape Cod to Cape Sable, each resting his claim upon different grants by the French. D'Aulney was a Catholic and La Tour a Protestant, and their ferocity against each other found no counterpart at any time in the savage denizens of the primitive forests. Yet they guarded the coasts watchfully, to prevent any inroads on the part of the English. A few days before the establishment of Mr. Vines' trading wigwam, he encountered La Tour on the waters, to the east of Machias. An altercation ensued between some of Vines' men and those of La Tour, when the latter made prisoners of the former. But, at the entreaty of Vines, they were released with "grave and good counsel," and he was allowed to sell what goods he had, as he proceeded back to Plymouth. But the grave and good counsel was little heeded, and Vines went directly to Machias with his five men, set up his trading house and fortified it, after which, leaving an armed shallop, he returned home. But this establishment was of short continuance, for two days after Vines had left, La Tour cast anchor at Machias. One of the Englishmen went on board his vessel for some purpose, and four of La Tour's men went on shore. It would appear that the English were intoxicated, for they endeavored to fire their guns, but failed. However, the French, in retreating, even before the non-resistants upon the shore, by accident, (as La Tour says,) fired one of their guns, killing two of the English. The remainder, with the goods, were seized and sent to France.*

Winthrop's Journal, Vol. 1, p. 117, 1633, has the following in relation to the taking of Machias by La Tour:

"Mr. Allerton of Plymouth, and some others, had set up a trading wigwam there, and left in it five men and store of commodities. La Tour, governor of the French in those parts, making claim to the place, came to displace them, and finding resistance, killed two of the men, and carried away the other three, and the goods."

A further account of the transaction is contained in Winthrop's Journal, Vol. 2, p. 126.

La Tour being at Boston, answered to several charges preferred against him:

"And whereas he, (La Tour,) was charged to have killed two Englishmen at Machias not far from his fort, and to have taken away their goods to the value of 500 pounds. Mr. Vines of Saco, who was principal trader, and part owner of the goods, etc., being present with La Tour, the governor heard the cause between them, which was thus: Mr. Vines being in a pinnace trading in those parts, La Tour met him in another pinnace, and bought so many of his commodities as Mr. Vines received then of him 400 skins, and although some of Mr. Vines his company had abused La Tour, whereupon he made them prisoners in his pinnace, and yet at Mr. Vines' entreaty he discharged them with grave and good council, and acquainted Mr. Vines with his commission to make prize of all such as should come to trade in those parts, and thereupon desired him peaceably to forbear, etc., yet at his request he gave him leave to trade the goods he had left, in his way home, so he did not fortify or build within his commission, which he said he could not answer if he should suffer it, whereupon they parted friendly. Mr. Vines landed his goods at Machias, and there set up a small wigwam, and left five men and two "murderers," (as the cannon were called,) to defend it, and a shallop, and so returned home. Two days after, La Tour comes, and casting anchor before the place, one of Mr. Vines' men came on board his pinnace, and while they were in parley, four of La Tour his men went on shore. One of the four which were in the house, seeing them, gave fire to a murderer, but it not taking fire, he called to his fellow to give fire to the other murderer, which he going to do, the four French retreated, and one of their muskets went off. (La Tour sayeth it was by accident, and that the shot went off through one his fellow's clothes, but Mr. Vines could say nothing to that.) It killed two of the men on shore, which La Tour professed himself innocent of, and very sorry for; and said further, that the five men were at that time all drunk, and not unlikely, having store of wine and strong water, for had they been sober, they would not have given fire upon such as they had conversed friendly with but two days before, without once bidding them stand, or asking them wherefore they came. After this, La Tour coming to the house, and finding some of his own goods, (though of no great value,) which had a little before had been taken out of his fort at St. John's, he seized the three men and the goods, and sent them to France."

The existence of a fixed settlement at Machias, from the time of Vines' establishment up to 1675, is a matter of question. One unsuccessful attempt was made on the part of the French. In 1688, under the direction of Governor Andros, a census of the inhabitants from Penobscot to Passamaquoddy, was taken, and nine persons were found at Machias, probably the relics of the French attempt at a settlement, judging from the names,—Martel, (single,) Bretoon and Lattre, (heads of families,) nine in all. At this time King William's war broke out. Egremet was the Indian chief here, and was concerned in the attack upon Wells. A treaty was finally made, and signed by thirteen Sagamores, (chiefs,) and others of the tribe. The facsimiles of the signers, and their names, we have seen in the papers of the late Wm. D. Williamson. They are curious enough, and some of the names,—as Francois Xavier,—show that the French Jesuits had the bestowing of them. In 1674 the incursions of the French and Indians upon the frontier, decided the commonwealth to take active measures of defence. The command of the forces devolved upon Major Church, but though specially directed to land at Machias, we do not find in the narrative of his five expeditions, any account of his operations here. The after-ensuing Indian wars prevented any progress of settlements to the east of Piscataquis. On the cessation of hostilities in 1761, the inhabitants of New England, returning from dangerous forest wars, laid down the musket to take up the peaceful implements of agriculture.

The year 1761 was one of terrible drouth,—a calamity that, while it seemed to threaten the very existence of the colony, still had the effect to disperse the inhabitants, and to open up new settlements, amongwhich was Machias.

It is well to contemplate the trials of our ancestors at this period. These should be so many lessons to us, their decendants. Before the drought, the colony had been plunged in despondency by an epidemical sickness. The strong arm which had shielded the defenceless when the war-cry broke upon the drowsy ear of night, suddenly became nerveless and wasted. The ruddy cheek of woman, whose love and affection had given new strength to the faltering and weary march of the pioneer soldier, became pallid in death. A dark cloud like a pall obscured the sun of peace that seemed dawning upon the early settlers. Then came the drought. The times seemed out of joint. "The leafy month of June" put on the sombre habiliments of autumn. Vegetation was parched and dead. The green leaves of the forest died upon the trees, and were blown about by the hot winds of the south. Cattle perished for food and water, upon the dusty beds where large streams had run. The husbandman saw his spring hopes perish under the ardent eye of the sun. Days and weeks passed, and no rain came. As if to crown the affliction of the people, great fires burst out in the forest. The settler cast his eye over the hills and valleys, and beheld them a sea of flames. Here and there a higher column would mark the locality of a vanishing habitation.

During the years of 1761-2 the towns of Scarborough, Gorham, and Yarmouth suffered severely. Men came to love the ocean because it was water. They went down to the glimmering sea. They sought out new habitations where the salt marshes furnished hay for their cattle. During the years of 1761-2 excursions were made with this object from Falmouth, (Portland,) and Scarborough. Thus it was in 1762 that Isaiah Foster and Isaac Larrabee came as far as Machias River. They returned with hearts light and joyous. The story of their voyage and discovery was soon told, and in the winter of 1763, a company of sixteen was formed, whose object was the settlement of the place and erection of mills. Hither they came and planted themselves, and from that time the old town of Machias had "a local habitation, and *a name*," untarnished and bright through all the revolution. We give the names of these pioneers, those of the same name being brothers:—Samuel Scott, Sylvanus Scott, Timothy Libby, George Libby, David Libby, Solomon Stone, John Stone, Daniel Hill, Japhet Hill, Isaiah Foster, Westbrook Berry, Isaac Larrabee, Daniel Fogg, Thomas Buck, (captain of a coaster,) Jonathan Carlton, of Sheepscot, Wm. Jones, of Portsmouth.

This was the infant colony that was planted at Machias, and from which originated many families now living in Eastern Maine. There were twenty-five persons in all,—there being two families. They set sail in April, 1763, and after a stormy passage arrived on the 20th of May.

A journal of this voyage was kept by Mr. Fogg. It was once in the possession of Micajah J. Talbot, of East Machias, but was lost by the burning of the house of Mr. Jesse Scott. This incident illustrates the importance of preserving such interesting papers by copying. Space will not permit us to narrate the progress of the new colony,—how mills were erected,—how eleven wives of so many partners came in a schooner commanded by the father of the late Col. Joseph Wallace, now of Harrington, and some of whose decendants who had wives were held in the highest esteem and were covered by boards, while the others lived in log houses,—how sixteen M. feet of lumber was sawed in 1764,—how the colony increased by birth and immigration,—how among others came captain Ichabod Jones, of Boston, (1765) and joined a part of the inhabitants in building a mill in East Machias,—how the nephew of Ichabod, Mr. Stephen Jones also came here from Boston, and became a man of note and a magistrate,—how then there were 25 families and the same number of single men, but no maidens here, and how the inhabitants petitioned Nova Scotia for a grant of land. One incident however interests us. The plantation had been supplied with most of its provisions from abroad. In the winter of 1767 the vessel with provisions and stores was impeded by ice. A great scarcity which threatened destruction of the settlement, followed. The little flour saved for starch was consumed,—the men had hardly strength to dig for clams and eels,—how to hunt the deer and moose was unknown,—the sea offered almost the only subsistence;—but the people kept courage and were thankful for what they got as was the Cape Cod parson, who living at such a time, enjoyed his dish of clams, returning thanks to God, who had "giving him to suck of the abundance of the seas, and of treasures hid in the sands!"

In 1768 Jonathan Longfellow was appointed justice of the peace, the first civil appointment east of Penobscot. The swains of Machias had no longer to go to Boston to procure the tying of the nuptial knot, and thelegitimising of the pledges of affection. The next year a militia company of nearly a hundred men were raised and Stephen Jones was made captain, Benj. Foster lieutenant, and Sylvanus Scott ensign. Their commissions are of date Aug. 2d, "in the ninth year of the reign of his majesty George the Third." It was a company of foot, and belonged to the regiment of Col. Thomas Goldthwait. This year the inhabitants ("great part of whom served his majesty in the late wars,") petitioned for a grant of land. The petition was signed by eighty persons in all. It was granted upon certain conditions, and the grant was sent home to his majesty for confirmation. In July, 1771, the town raised a sum to hire a minister of the gospel, and their action resulted in the engagement of Rev. James Lyon, who had been settled in Nova Scotia. In 1774 the first church was built.

Now, we come to the revolutionary history of Machias, which had grown to be the most considerable town in Eastern Maine.

In April of the year 1774, Capt. Ichabod Jones, (who was still interested in property at Machias,) came here on a visit with his family. Apprehensive that trouble might arise between the northern country and the colonists, (the Boston port bill being the cause of a constant state of excitement in Boston,) Capt. Jones remained through the summer and winter. In April of '75 or early in May, the news of the battle of Lexington reached Machias. The inhabitants partook of the sentiments of their brethren in Massachusetts. About this time the two vessels belonging to Capt. Jones, loaded with lumber, and proceeded to Boston. He desired to bring away from Boston other of his property, together with provisionments for the inhabitants of Machias, and also articles of traffic. In order to leave Boston, it was necessary to procure a permit from Admiral Grover, in command there. This was granted on condition that the sloops (the Unity and the Polly) should return with lumber for the use of the British. The admiral also ordered the British armed schooner Margaretta, of about 100 tons, carrying 40 men, and commanded by midshipman Moore, to accompany them, probably for the double purpose of seeing that Captain Jones should make his stipulation good, and also to protect the sloops, should any interfere to prevent their return. Capt. Jones also got from the selectmen of Boston a certificate, desiring the people to allow his return. In June the little fleet arrived at Machias. Capt. Jones laid before the inhabitants, in public meeting, his proposition to return with lumber, and to continue that traffic with Boston, so essential to the necessities of the place. The majority voted to allow this. But the vessels commenced loading a kind of lumber suitable for barracks. A suspicion arose that Capt. Jones had as much at heart the serving of the royal cause as the interests of the town. The wrongs of the colonists were fresh in the minds of the people, and the battle of Lexington had warmed their blood, and nerved them up to some deed of daring. Much as Machias must suffer by the interruption of a communication with Boston, it was decided in secret meeting that the vessels should not return. Capt. Benj. Foster, who had been a soldier at the seige of Louisbourg,* conceived the design, not only of preventing the return of the sloops, but of taking the British vessel.

Captain Foster called a secret meeting of the principal citizens of the place, and of the localities west so far as Gouldsboro'. The question at issue was warmly discussed as related to expediency on the one hand, and a patriotic duty on the other. Foster impatient at the discussion, stepped across a brook and invited those who would join the expedition to follow. A large majority went over at once, and the rest hastened to follow, ashamed of having been behind the foremost in the patriotic enterprise.

This was Sunday, the 11th of June 1775. The officers of the Margaretta were at church. A plan for their immediate capture was conceived. An armed band started to surround the church. One Loudon Atis, a colored man, saw the warlike party from the open window of the church, and unaware of the object gave the outcry. The officers succeeded in getting on board the Margaretta, then lying at White's Point, weighed anchor and dropped down below the Narrows, sending word to the inhabitants that if Jones' sloops were hinderd from following they would return and destroy the town. But Foster and his party did not intend to stop here. The two sloops were impressed into the service and one of them put under command of Jeremiah O'Brien with 40 men, while Foster went to the East Village for a schooner called the Falmouth Packet. The little fleet came together in the harbor in the morning, but before the action could be commenced, Foster's vessel got aground, and O'Brien was left to meet the enemy in the sloop. It is a singular comment upon the reckless bravery of the times, that no commander was chosen till the vessels were about to engage, when O'Brien was unanimously chosen chief. Capt. O'Brien at once formed the plan of boarding the Margaretta. Indeed, the character of this armament admitted of no other course. Midshipman Moore hailed the sloop, and declared he would fire into her unless she kept off. In reply, O'Brien ordered him to surrender, while Stevens, in equally patriotic spirit, but with less regard to biblical precepts, told him to "fire away and be d—ned!" Moore, wishing to avoid a collision, crowded all sail, but in gibing carried away his bowsprit. Rigging another spar, he stood to sea, cutting away his boats to give the vessel greater speed. This was ineffectual, and the Margaretta was brought into action. She fired into the sloop. The fire was returned with animation and effect. The vessels fell together, the sloop going bows on. A sharp musket shot ensued. Moore fell while throwing hand grenades in person, and the schooner was boarded. One Joseph Getchell and Capt. O'Brien sprang upon the deck at the same moment. Capt. Moore's second in command made no further resistance, and the first British armed vessel taken in the revolution, surrendered at discretion.

On our side, one was killed, one mortally and three badly wounded. On board the Margaretta, four were killed besides the captain, who was mortally wounded, and who, with all the care lavished upon him by his generous enemy, died at Machias the next day. The Margaretta, and her crew as prisoners of war, were brought to Machias village on Monday, the 12th of June. It is said that there were two ladies on board the M., to one of whom Capt. Moore was soon to have been married. Of the actors in this bold enterprise, the names of the following only have been preserved,—unless, indeed, they may be found in the court records of Wiscasset: Jeremiah O'Brien, Edmund Stevens, (then of Addison,) Gideon O'Brien, John O'Brien, Wm. O'Brien, Richard Earl, (a negro,) Samuel Watts, Jona. Knight, Steel, Murritt, Weston, Barry, Taft, Cole, Coolbroth, McNeil, Cridiforth, Hall, and Wheaton. Many individual acts of prowess on the part of the crew are related. Knights joined the party, leaving his wife in a delicate situation, and sending another for a nurse. O'Brien, when in sight of the enemy, told his crew that any who wanted to leave, might. Two or three accepted, under the derision of others. Nor were the bolder sex alone in the enterprise. A man had been despatched to Jonesboro' for powder, but from some cause refused to return. The men were absent. The women took counsel together. The elder females were required to take care of the infants. Two girls offered their services,—Hannah Watts, who was aged seventeen, and Rebecca Weston, aged nineteen years. By spotted trees, they came through to Machias, bringing some 30 lbs. of powder and ball. Almost overcome by fatigue, they arrived at sunset, and stopped at the house of 'Squire Longfellow. The patriotic citizens rewarded the brave girls with a present of twelve yards of camblet. The account of the capture of the Margaretta, (as tradition has it,) was carried to Boston by Loudon Atis, the colored steward of Rev. James Lyon.

We have been thus minute in this narrative, (drawn almost wholly, so far as its particulars are concerned, from the papers of Mr. Smith,) because it was the first naval action of the revolution, and because it substantiates the name of Machias Bay to the proud title our naval historian has put upon it, "The Lexington of the Seas." This capture also contributed to the formation of that nucleus which has now grown to be the American Navy. One of the sloops of Capt. Jones was fitted with the guns of the Margaretta, and during the war made important captures.

The inhabitants of Machias had now boldly assumed the patritic position they held during the revolution. They immediately put themselves in a condition for defensive and offensive operation. From this time, through their committee of correspondence, inspection and safety, the citizens of Machias were constantly acting in conjunction with the continental army and the general court of Massachusetts.

It was not to be expected that the position they had assumed would escape the attention of the British. In the summer of 1777, Sir George Collier, in his majesty's ship the Rainbow (the flag ship), of 44 guns, accompanied by the Blonde, 32 guns, the Mermaid, 28 guns, and the Hope, 18 guns, after a service along the coast so far as New York, arrived at Machias the 12th of August. The inhabitants were on the alert for the defence of the place. Breastworks were thrown up. Capt. Dawson, of the Hope, ascended the river, drove the Americans from one defence, and burnt several houses, barns and mills. The women and children were sent off. A large number of friendly Passamaquoddy Indians were here, waiting the arrival of troops designed to make an expedition against Nova Scotia. There were two military companies here,—one under the command of Benj. Foster, at East Machias, and one at what is now Machias, under Stephen Smith. A detachment, under George Stillman, was detailed to guard the southern bank of West river. Capt. Foster had charge of the breastworks and boom, and Capt. Smith, with the Indians and some citizens, were at the breastworks on White's Point, half a mile below the village of West Machias, near the present bridge over the mouth of Middle river.

The Hope was continually harrassed by musket shots in ascending the river. Below the Point the Hope's boats were sounding. Though out of gunshot, the Indians, who, in addition to the ordinary excitement of the occasion, were animated by "much rum," could hardly be restrained. Francis Joseph Neptune asked leave to try his skill on an officer standing in the boat. The first shot went over, but at the second the officer fell, whereupon the savages uttered a most diabolical yell. The boat returned to the Hope, and Capt. Dawson dropped down river, harassed all the way. She twice got aground, but the last time out of the reach of musket shot. The citizens got a small cannon, and covering it with a blanket, and in solemn imitation of a funeral procession, placed it in a position to fire with effect upon the Hope. But the tide serving, the vessel joined her consorts, and, in a day or two, all proceeded to Halifax. We think this was the only deliberate naval attack of the enemy during the revolution, that failed. The number killed and wounded on the part of the British is variously estimated, at from thirty to one hundred. On our side, one was killed and one wounded. Sir George Collier has a pompous account of the affair, from which he would make it appear to have been a brilliant exploit. He says "the habitations of the people and all private property were spared," as he "wished to bring back those infatuated people by acts of lenity rather than severity."

We have not room to narrate the many patriotic acts of the people of Machias during the war,—how the Rev. James Lyon, actuated by a spirit of godly zeal in a good cause, often applied to Washington for leave to raise an expedition which he, with Cromwellian ardor, was to lead against Nova Scotia,—how the inhabitants indignantly rejected propositions to take a passive part, and thereby enjoy their trade with Boston,—how Col. John Allen's forces, with the friendly Indians, protected all this coast, and saved one half of Maine to the confederacy.

We have now passed the period of the revolution. Out of it the people of Machias emerged, having every title to the high estimation of their compatriots and of their posterity. We are now come to a period which has no collated history. There may not be much of interest in it. The time between laying down the battered arms of the revolution, and taking up those of the last war with England, were prosperous times with the people of Eastern Maine. They had well earned their prosperity.

About the 14th of September, 1814, after the taking of Castine, a portion of the expedition, with six or eight sail, invested Machias, leaving Commodore Milne and General Gosselyn in command at the former place. At Machias there was a fort, (O'Brien, named in honor of the captor of the Margaretta,) garrisoned by fifty regulars, some militia, and auxiliaries from Robbinston, under Captain Leonard. The place was taken without opposition, and the works destroyed. By the light of the burning barracks the British evacuated the place.

* In connection with this affair, we may mention one of those episodes that lend to the history of Maine the interest of romance, and which so diversify its various shades. D'Aulney had a large trading station at Castine, and La Tour had a similar establishment at the mouth of the Saint John. Their wives were with them. Madame La Tour is represented as having been a lady of great intelligence and spirit. In 1641, being on her way from London to join her husband at St. John, she was carried to Boston. She immediately prosecuted the captain for a breach of his contract, and recovered £2000. On the passage she had narrowly escaped being taken by D'Aulney.

With the money recovered, Madame La Tour chartered three vessels to proceed to the St. John. Again she escaped D'Aulney, who, enraged at failing to secure so illustrious a captive, in 1645, in the absence of La Tour from St. John, attacked the place, then in command of Madame La Tour. But D'Aulney had underrated the prowess of a brave woman. Madame took the command, and opened so brisk a fire that the enemy had twenty killed and thirteen wounded. The ship was warped out of the range of the guns to prevent her going to the bottom. The following year, during the absence of La Tour, the fort was again attacked by a larger force, and taken. All were put to the sword but Madame La Tour, who was taken prisoner. Separated from her husband,—bereft of her estates,—a prisoner of the Catholics whose swords had driven her from France to find a free asylum in the New World,—a captive in the castle of her most implacable enemy;—her brave spirit, which was above the fear of danger, was broken by grief and desolation, and in three weeks from the day of her spirited defense and final overthrow, she died broken-hearted.

The contentions of these two chieftains have formed the subject of an agreeable romance, published at Boston in 1828, entitled "The Rivals of Acadie." Whittier, the poet, has written a short poem on the subject of their controversies, which is contained in the collection of his writings. Those who have any curiosity to read a detailed account of La Tour and D'Aulney, will find in Littell's Living Age, No. 311, for May 4, 1850, an interesting sketch of their lives and times. The article is headed, "La Tour in Boston."

* The second taking of Louisbourg was in 1759. Lorenzo Sabine, in his interesting work on our fisheries, has the following: "The prominent actors in the wars of 1744 and 1756, were the prominent actors in the struggle for freedom." Thornton, who became a signer of the Declaration,—Col. Bradford and Gridley, who laid out the works at Bunker Hill, were at the seige of Louisbourg.

A human being with nothing to do.—Most miserable, worthy of most profound pity, is such a being. The most insignificant object in nature becomes a source of envy. The birds warble on every spray in ecstacy of joy; the tiny flower, hidden from all eyes, sends forth its fragrance of full happiness; the mountain stream dashes along with a sparkle and a murmur of pure delight. The object of their creation is accomplished, and their life gushes forth in harmonic work. Oh, plant! oh, stream! worthy of admiration, of worship, to the wretched idler. Here are powers ye never dreamed of, faculties divine, eternal; a head to think, but nothing to concentrate the thoughts; a heart to love, but no object to bathe with the living tide of affection; a hand to do, but no work to be done, talents unexercised, capacities undeveloped; a human life thrown away, wasted as water poured forth in the desert. Birds and flowers, ye are gods to such a mockery of life! who can describe the fearful void of such an existence, the yearning for an object, the self reproach for wasted hopes the weariness of life, the loathing of pleasure, of fearful consciousness of deadening life; of a spiritual paralysis, which hinders all response to human interests; when enthusiasm ceases to arouse, and noble deeds no longer call forth the tear of joy; when the world becomes a blank, humanity a far-off sound, and no life is left but the heavy benumbing weight of personal hopelessness and desolation. Happier far is the toiling drudge who coins body and soul into the few poor shillings that can only keep his family in a long starvation; he has hope unceasingly to light him, a duty to perform, a spark of love within that cannot die; and wretched, weary, unhuman as his life may be, it is of royal worth; it is separated by the immeasurable distance of life and death from the poor, perhaps pampered, wretch who is cursed for having no work to do.

A Hoosier's Description of a dinner at the Astor House.—I met upon the train an elderly hoosier, who had been to the show case exhibition at New York, and who had also seen the *Hi pod ro me*, as he called it.

"Did you remain long in New York?" I asked him.

"Well, no," answered he, thoughtfully, "only two days, for I saw there was a right smart chance of starving to death, and I'm opposed to that way of going down. I put up to one of their taverns, and I allowed I was going to be treated to the whole."

"Where did you stop," said I interrupting him.

"At the *Ashtore house*. I allow you don't ketch me to no such place agin. They rung a *gone* as they called it, four times afore breakfast, and then when I went in to eat, there was not any vittles on the table."

"What *was* there?" I ventured to enquire.

"Well," said the old man enumerating the items cautiously, as if from fear of omission, "there was a clean plate—wrong side up—a knife, a *clean tewel, a split spoon, and a hand bill*, and what was worse," added my companion, "the insultin' nigger up and asked me what I wanted; 'vittles,' said I, *'bring in your vittles and I'll help myself.'*"

A waterlogged ship.—A timber-laden ship, the Wolfe, has arrived in the Mersey in a water-logged state. The circumstances attending her perilous voyage are curious. The Wolfe sailed from Quebec for this port last autumn, but got ashore at St. Peter's Island, near Cape Breton. She remained ashore, encompassed by the ice, all winter, and while lying there was purchased as a wreck. Early in the spring of the present year she was got afloat again, and reached Pictou, but in consequence of the little rise of tide there, she could not be repaired at that port, nor could a steamer be procured to tow her to Quebec. Under these circumstances the present owners determined to send her over, waterlogged as she was, to this port, and take the risk; and for this purpose she was placed in charge of Capt. Evan Crerar, who, by enterprise and care, succeeded in bringing her safely into port without further damage, and with all hands hearty and well, although she was drawing 24 feet of water.—*European Times.*

The Journey Across the Isthmus of Suez.—The following description of the state of the road, and of the mode of traveling from Cairo to Suez, on the route of the overland mail to India, is from a late Paris Journal.

From Cairo to Suez there is about thirty hours of travel; camels take from two to three days to traverse it; merchandise wagons one day, and the horse post a little less. Cairo and Suez communicate by a high road kept in good order. The India mail takes this route; sixteen stations have been established for it to change horses. These stations are all square buildings of a single story, with a court yard in the centre. They resemble the *chalets* of Switzerland. The traveler, dying with thirst and oppressed by fatigue, perceives them with real joy, for he is always sure of finding there a good stock of water drawn from the Nile. They are always provided with necessary comforts.

The desert begins at the gates of Cairo. After once entering it, no verdure is met, except a miserable herb, which serves as pasture to the camels as they pass, and two or three solitary trees. One of the latter, an old and large sycamore, at about midway, is the object of great veneration among the Bedouins. All the pilgrims of Mecca suspend there some portions of their wardrobe to obtain a prosperous voyage. In Egypt a number of these trees is met, to which the people attribute a marvelous virtue. It is the tree under whose shade it is said Joseph and Mary reposed; it is the same as that of the Island of Rhodes, not far from Cairo, which has the property of removing barrenness from women. The soil on the entire route after leaving Cairo is hard and stoney, so that, if it be designed to build a railroad here, there will be nothing to apprehend from the moving sands. It would be an error to suppose that the desert is one eternal plain. The route is traversed by a range of small hills, which offer to the eye new points of view—the passage of a single bird rejoices the heart, for it is a proof that living nature has penetrated into this valley of death.

Now and again a caravan passes; the camels advance with equal step, one after another, loaded with the treasures of India—Mocha coffee, mother of pearl from the Red Sea, gum from Arabia, and African ivory. The caravan is saluted with "Salam-aleikam," and everything becomes still again. You are once more master of the solitude, for no one is there to dispute it with you, save the sanguinary hyena, which watches in the gloom the tired camels. When one traverses this sea of sand, the imagination, excited by the heat of the day and the profound calm of the night, is pleased in evoking strange forms; thus, to me, a chateau appeared to rise from the midst of the sand, its windows resplendent with fantastic light.

We walk on towards the light; already we are approaching the walls, but we perceive that they are the telegraph buildings. After a journey of two nights and one day, we arrive at Suez. This little city is supported by navigation and transit commerce. The inhabitants are, for the most part, sailors of the Jor and its neighborhood. The pilgrimage to Mecca produces, particularly, great benefits to it; but this year the greater part of the pilgrims have gone by land to Kosseir. There are about thirty Europeans settled in this city, who are engaged in the transit to India. Suez is surrounded on all sides by the desert, and provisions must therefore be brought to it from a great distance. The water drank there has a very disagreeable, miry taste. The traveler who has come from the Nile cannot accustom himself to it, and the Frenchman is also right in saying that the water of the Nile is far from champagne.

Varieties.

"Is your watch a lever?" "Lever, yes. I have to leave her once a week at the watchmaker's for repairs."

The men who flatter women do not know them sufficiently, and the men who only abuse them, do not know them at all.

An exchange paper tells us of the sad case of a man who was shipwrecked and cast upon an uninhabited island, without a shilling in his pocket.

A western paper contains the following advertisement: "Two sisters want washing." We hope they may be washed.

The less a man needs money, the more he worships it. Misers are always people with small appetites and no children.

"Mike, and is it yerself that can be afther telling me how they make ice crame?" "In truth I can—don't they bake them in cowld ovens to be sure."

The substance of the verdict of a recent coroners jury on a man who died in a state of inebriation, was—"Death by hanging—round a rum shop."

The Albany Knickerbocker lately received a letter, inquiring, among other things, whether pig iron was petrified pork, and if it was, which was the best way to cook it to make it juicy.

Talk much with any man of vigorous mind, and we acquire very fast the habit of looking at things in the same light, and on each occurrence we anticipate his thought.

Hats worn on the heads of a discourse—the bucket that hung in All's well, and some of the fragments of the man who burst into tears, are said to be the last curiosities found.

When a man takes a full morning bath, nine million mouths are open to thank him; for every pore of the skin has separate cause to be grateful for its daily ablution.

"How do you accomplish so much in so short a time?" said a friend to Sir Walter Raleigh.

"When I have anything to do, I go and do it," was the reply.

"My German friend, how long have you been married?" "Vell, dis a thing that I seldom don't like to taulk about, but ven I does, it seems so long that it never was."

An exchange wisely remarks that no dust affects the eyes so much as *gold dust*. We might also add, that no *glasses* affect the eyes more unfavorably than *glasses of brandy.*

Arithmetic is differently studied by fathers and sons; the first confining themselves to addition, and the second to subtraction.

The Boston Times says that Europe "is a very respectable portion of the world, no doubt, but antiqueted, and not so influential as formerly."

Grocers, who sell sweet peas for "old government Java," should remember their latter end, and bear in mind that "Jordan is a hard road to travel." Things are not judged by their "labels in the other world.

Prosperity, too often has the same effect on a Christian that a calm sea has on a Dutch mariner, who frequently, as it is said, in those circumstances, ties up the rudder, gets drunk and goes to sleep.

The word "Porte" is derived from a version given by Italian interpreters to an Oriental prraise. It was an ancient custom of eastern sovereignty, in administering justice, or exercising other functions of their office, to sit, as the Scriptural expressions run, at the *gate* of their palaces. Gate became thus synonymous with "court" or "office," and the Sultan's court was called by excellence, the *exalted*, or *lofty gate*. This phrase, in the literal translations of the Dragomen, who were mostly Italians, became *La Porta Sublime*, whence the title of the *Sublime Porte*. To the same source we have the term "Grand Seignior," as applied to the Ottoman Emperor.—*Troy Post.*

LOCAL IMPRESSIONS.

When on the wide seas, sailors frequently think they hear their village bells; and the author of Eothen mentions hearing the chimes of his native village while travelling through the desert. Simple objects are invariably those which awaken the most tender recollections; nay, their insignificance, under some circumstances, enhances their effect. "Whilst we were at dinner," says Captain King, "in this miserable hut, on the banks of the river Awatska,—the guests of a people with whose existence we had before been scarce acquainted, and at the extremity of the habitable globe,—a solitary half-worn pewter spoon, whose shape was familiar to us, attracted our attention; and on examination, we found it stamped on the back with the word *London*. I cannot pass over this circumstance in silence, out of gratitude for the many pleasant thoughts, the anxious hopes and tender remembrances it excited in us." We are told of a visit which Johnson paid not long before his death, which gave him infinite delight,—it was to the hollow tree at Litchfield, of which he had been fond in his boyish days.

Macaulay, in speaking of local attachment, says that it is generally found strongest in great minds. He quotes from Lord Clive's letters to show how, in the scenes of excitement and grandeur, his heart yearned after his home. "If I should be so far blest," he says, "as to revisit again my native country, but more especially Manchester, the centre of all my wishes, all that I could hope for or desire would be presented before me in one view." He tells us how powerfully Warren Hastings was attached to the seat of his ancestors in Daylesford, in Worcestershire; the family being unable to keep it up, had sold it to a merchant in London. Macaulay goes on to say: "The day seeing the lands which his ancestors had possessed, and which had passed into the hands of strangers, filled his young brain with wild fancies and projects. One bright summer day, the boy, just then seven years old, lay on the banks of the rivulet which runs through and irrigates the old domain of his house to join the Iris; there,—at threescore-and-ten years later he told the tale,—rose on his mind a scheme which, through all the turns of his eventful career, was never abandoned; he would recover the estate which belonged to his father,—he would be Hastings of Daylesford. When, under a tropical sun, he ruled fifty millions of Asiatics, his hopes, amidst all the cares of war, finance and legislation, still pointed to Daylesford; and when his long public life, so singularly varied with good and evil, with glory and obloquy, had at length closed for ever, it was to Daylesford he retired to die."

It is, indeed, most affecting to see the home which has been hallowed by affection, and endeared by the earliest recollections, pass into the hands of strangers. Poor Cowper, in his youth, had this to lament. It never occurred to him that the glebe where his father lived belonged to the parish rectory he held, and was not his own property. The sorrow he felt when he found it about to be inhabited by another, is so affectingly touched on by himself, that it should be given by no other words: "There was neither tree, nor gate, nor stile in all that country, to which I did not feel a relation; and the house itself I preferred to a palace. I was sent for from London to attend my father in his last illness, and he died just before I arrived; then, and not till then, I felt for the first time that I and my native place were disunited for ever. I sighed a long adieu to fields and woods, from which I once thought I never should be parted, and was at no time so sensible of their beauties, as just when I left them all behind me, to return no more."

The early haunts of imaginative persons influence to a great degree their future reveries,—the solitude in which fancy had full sway,—the woods, where the muses were first heard,—the streams, from whose pure fountains inspiration was first imbibed, are worth all the fame and fortune that future years can gleam. It has been told, and on good authority, that when the Marquis of Wellesley was an old man, after he had been governor-general of India, and had filled one of the highest ministerial offices in England, he one day went to the new forest. Sixty years had elapsed since he had been last there, but its scenes were never to be forgotten. It was there he had met one whom he had passionately loved, one who had fondly returned his affection, and who had died in the brightness of her youth. The lustre and activity of a long life were forgotten in the dearer recollections associated with the scenes of these early loves. Every morning he drove to the immediate vicinity of the abode where they had been domesticated, and there, alighting from his carriage, he would wander through all the paths they used to tread, to feel too deeply that "ambition is no cure for love."

Memorials are scattered here and there, which tell how the thoughts of a long-absent one have been in the home of his fathers. We were much interested in an account of a faithful servant, who was leaving the services of a cardinal in Rome, that he might pass the remnant of his days in his native village. His master, wishing to give him some substantial proof of the estimation in which he held his long-tried fidelity, desired him to name any article in the palace which he would wish to take with him. The servant declared his choice,—it was the picture of our Saviour's removal from the cross, by Guido, at which he had often looked in the cardinal's gallery. It was what he would have,—he would present it to the church of his native village. The cardinal was somewhat confounded, but his promise was given, and he allowed the picture to be taken away by the servant; and in the remote village of Petit Bernaud, in a wild, secluded valley, this noble specimen of art, by one of the first masters, is to be found.

Fashionable Life in New York.—Brass isn't gold just because it glistens for a while, nor are people always happy because they dress well and live sumptuously. The N. Y. Day Book thus refers to fashionable life in that city. It would apply to other localities:

"The recent affair at Newport, has rather made a sensation in upper-ten-dom. A fashionable young man, who happens to have a rich and sharp old chap for a father, undertook to flog his wife. We know something about the parties, and could make a very readable paragraph on the subject, but the Day Book has no taste for developments of this kind. It is well enough however, to remark that our readers cannot imagine what dreadful and what unhappy lives are led by the fashionable parvenus of New York. Bless your stars, reader, that you are not of the number of those who, without education, without principle, without antecedents, except such as to crimson the cheek; bless your stars that you are not rich and live in a large house, with a dissipated wife or a dissipated husband, that you have not been spoiled by the follies of a Parisian life, and the example of returned roues. If one-half of what is talked of openly at the clubs found its way to the public, that public would roll up its eyes, and they would stay rolled up."

A villain unkennelled.—The Ellsworth *Herald* hauls down the black flag of its late editor-in-chief, George S. Raymond. It joins in the exposure of the man of many *aliases*. He fled from Ellsworth several days since. The charges made against him are that he has a wife and several children in Oswego, N. Y., who are supported by the untiring industry of the abandoned wife and mother,—also that he has had a wife with him at Ellsworth, who, the *Herald* says, is an amiable woman, and deserving of the sympathy of the public. He is also charged with being guilty of fraud, &c., but his other sins are virtues compared with the first allegation. The *Herald* says he left Ellsworth just in season to escape the dreaded cast-iron band which is the public executioner in that thriving village.

It will be recollected that Mr. Raymond figured in the attempt to make out that we have a Bourbon among us,—by way of a statement which was made use of in the testimony of the case. The development of his character will somewhat damage that testimony. The *Herald* calls upon the press to pass him along.—*Bangor Mercury.*

A man's own conscience is his sole tribunal, and he should care no more for that phantom "opinion," than he should fear meeting a ghost if he crossed the church yard at dark.—*Bulwer.*